

Retail Company Analytics Assignment

Part A: RCTTCE Prompt

R – Role

Being a Senior Business Analytics Consultant with expertise in retail performance analysis, customer behavior, sales optimization, and executive reporting.

C – Context

A retail company with 30 stores has experienced declining business performance over the past 18 months. The CEO has asked the Analytics Team to investigate the causes and identify opportunities for improvement. The company has provided a dataset containing approximately 50,000 records covering store performance, product sales, customer transactions, and loyalty programme activity.

T – Task

Analyze the available data and prepare a stakeholder brief for the CEO. Identify potential drivers of declining performance, key business questions that should be investigated, and areas where management decisions may improve performance.

F – Format

Present the response using the following headings:

1. Situation Summary
2. Three Key Business Questions
3. Decisions These Questions Will Inform
4. Description of Available Data
5. Recommended Next Steps

Co – Constraints

- Keep the stakeholder brief under 250 words.
- Use professional business language.
- Focus on actionable insights rather than technical details.
- Assume the audience is senior executives with limited time.

E – Example

Example business question: “Has customer spending decreased because of reduced loyalty programme engagement?”

Example decision informed: “Whether to redesign loyalty rewards to improve customer retention and spending.”

Part B: AI-Generated Stakeholder Brief

Situation Summary

The company has experienced declining performance across its 30-store network over the last 18 months. To understand the causes, an analysis will be conducted using sales, customer transaction, store performance, and loyalty programme data. The objective is to identify trends, performance gaps, and opportunities to improve revenue and customer retention.

Three Key Business Questions

1. Which stores have experienced the largest decline in sales and what factors are contributing to the decline?
2. How have customer purchasing patterns changed during the last 18 months?
3. What impact has loyalty programme participation had on customer retention and spending?

Decisions These Questions Will Inform

- Whether product assortment, pricing, or promotional strategies require adjustment.
- Whether the loyalty programme should be redesigned to increase customer engagement and repeat purchases.

Description of Available Data

The dataset contains approximately 50,000 records covering store-level performance metrics, product sales information, customer transactions, and loyalty programme activity. Together, these datasets provide visibility into operational performance, customer behaviour, purchasing trends, and retention patterns.

Recommended Next Steps

Conduct detailed trend analysis, compare store performance, evaluate customer retention metrics, and assess loyalty programme effectiveness to identify key drivers of declining performance and opportunities for improvement.

Reflection

I structured the prompt using the RCTTCE framework to provide the AI with clear guidance on its role, objectives, and expected output. Including constraints and examples helps ensure the response remains concise, executive-focused, and aligned with the CEO's decision-making needs.